

ATTACK OF THE SEQUELS

Successors to popular franchises were announced at the E3, so expect a glut of sequels in the coming year:

Max Payne 2

Take-Two Interactive announced that the development of *Max Payne 2* has begun, and that Rockstar and Remedy will be designing the title.

No One Lives Forever 2

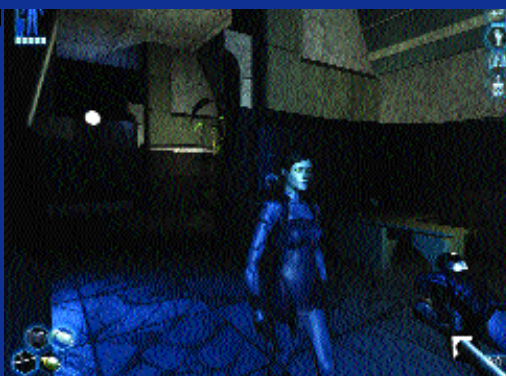
One of the finest first-person shooters since *Half-Life*, *No One Lives Forever* succeeded at being original, inventive and fun. Expectations are high for the sequel, which looks terrific and sports all of the various enhancements of the LithTech 3.0 3D engine.

Counter-Strike: Condition Zero

A stand-alone product, *Counter-Strike: Condition Zero* includes an upgraded version of the multiplayer title, as well as six story-driven episodes, three single player modes and various multiplayer enhancements.

Deus Ex 2003

Ion Storm moves forward with its dark, conspiracy-laden view of the Earth's future with this sequel to *Deus Ex*. The story and tweaks to gameplay will give players a feeling of the familiar, but with improved graphics and AI.

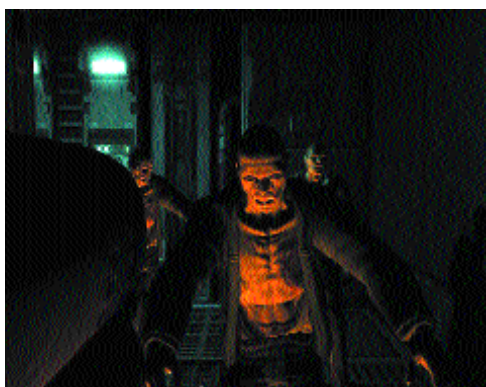


Star Trek: Elite Force 2

Star Trek: Elite Force is currently under development by Ritual and uses an enhanced version of the *Quake III* engine. You'll once again fill the boots of Alex Munro, a member of Voyager's Special Ops team, and even hop aboard the Enterprise along the way!

DOOM III

There's no question that id Software's highly anticipated shooter was the show-stopper and the most talked about game at E3. *DOOM III* is unbelievably detailed, and the engine's use of real-time lighting and shadows is miles ahead of any other



game created so far. The game will support Dolby 5.1 surround sound, and background music from Trent Reznor of Nine Inch Nails. Judging from the leaked videos doing the rounds on the Net, it's quite clear that *DOOM III* delivers its promises. The potential impact of id Software's new technology on future games makes *DOOM III* the top game of the show.

Battlefield: 1942

Battlefield: 1942 is an action game that places you in the middle of World War II, in levels set across four locations—the Pacific, Western Europe, Eastern Europe and North Africa. For most of the levels, the game features a Conquest mode in which you need to control flag points around the map for as long as possible. Apart from single player and multiplayer missions, you get to play the Capture the Flag, Death-match and Co-operative modes.



But the winning feature of the game is the nearly 40 controllable vehicles at your disposal. You will be able to run around with machine guns, bazookas and sniper rifles, but you can also hop into a jeep, a tank, a plane or even a submarine. Instead of taking a rigid simulation-style approach, *Battlefield*'s vehicle physics are pretty easy and forgiving, letting you spend more time dog-fighting than wrestling with the controls. The team has been doing a lot of balancing, making sure that no one vehicle or weapon or tactic will be too difficult to play with.

Matrix game

Amid the full fury of the E3, Warner Bros and EON Entertainment announced that they are in mid-production of a game based on *The Matrix*. It's being developed with the full support of EON, Warner Bros, LithTech and the Wachowski brothers. The new game will play out in a massively multiplayer online environment that recreates the world of *The Matrix*.

SRIRAM SHARMA

